

英検準1級 リーディング問題

2025年度 第1回

氏名 _____ 実施日 _____



解答方法 各問について、最も適切なものを1つ選び、問題冊子の選択肢に○を付けてください。

正解は最終ページにあります。すべて解いてから確認してください。

ReadPassで復習

大問1 語彙・文法 Q1-Q4

次の(1)から(18)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

- (1) Emergency services were having difficulty getting to the scene of the accident, so the police (1) traffic to another road to make space for ambulances and fire trucks.
1 infected 2 recited 3 galloped 4 diverted
- (2) The teacher suddenly lost his temper and shouted at the class to be quiet. Following his (2), all the students in the classroom went silent.
1 intake 2 outburst 3 breakup 4 layout
- (3) **A:** I've e-mailed Emily three times already to ask if she's coming to the party, but she hasn't responded.
B: That's odd. She usually gives such (3) replies.
1 slender 2 gloomy 3 abnormal 4 prompt
- (4) Researchers at the drug company have improved the (4) of their headache medicine. The pills are now twice as strong.
1 excursion 2 potency 3 friction 4 negligence

大問1 語彙・文法 Q5-Q9

次の(1)から(18)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

- (5) Using a smartphone while driving is now illegal in many places because it (5) drivers, who should always be watching the road.
1 distracts 2 reforms 3 pacifies 4 dismisses
- (6) In an effort to reduce government spending, the government has (6) the post office by allowing a for-profit corporation to take it over.
1 formulated 2 privatized 3 ventilated 4 deformed
- (7) Most of the topics discussed in the weekly meeting are (7) to his section, so Hans always takes his laptop so that he can spend the time replying to his e-mails.
1 occupied 2 invisible 3 irrelevant 4 anxious
- (8) After a storm, flooding can make roads (8). Motorists are advised to check that all roads on their planned routes are safe to drive on.
1 hazardous 2 vigorous 3 furious 4 monotonous
- (9) The store clerk told me my coupon was (9), so it could no longer be used. It had expired two months earlier.
1 acute 2 rash 3 invalid 4 imminent

大問1 語彙・文法 Q10-Q14

次の(1)から(18)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

(10) The unclear wording of the law meant that it had been legally possible to avoid paying taxes. Many people took advantage of this (10) before the law was finally changed this year.

- 1 loophole 2 stronghold 3 blueprint 4 aftermath

(11) Christine loved (11) colors, so she filled her apartment with bright red, yellow, and orange furnishings.

- 1 vivid 2 weary 3 hazy 4 feeble

(12) Although Jeffrey claimed it was an accident, Gretchen believed that he (12) knocked her books to the floor in order to make her angry.

- 1 greedily 2 obediently 3 intentionally 4 thoroughly

(13) In some countries, it is the (13) of families, not the government, to financially support senior citizens.

- 1 component 2 obligation 3 symptom 4 resolution

(14) Although many people like the idea of online learning, others feel that it is important for students to (14) with other children in person.

- 1 interact 2 collapse 3 precede 4 constrain

大問1 語彙・文法 Q15-Q18

次の(1)から(18)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

- (15) After retirement, many people (15) new hobbies that they did not have time for when they were working.
1 root out 2 pass for 3 take up 4 blow up
- (16) It took two weeks, but police were finally able to (16) the thieves using video from a security camera and fingerprints left at the crime scene.
1 bulk up 2 track down 3 lay off 4 pick on
- (17) Three boys were trying to enter the park late at night when they (17) an alarm. They ran away as soon as they heard it.
1 pressed for 2 put through 3 forked over 4 set off
- (18) Richard decided to (18) the job offer from the large company. Although the pay was good, he did not want to relocate his family to a new city.
1 work through 2 pass up 3 plow through 4 wind up

大問2A 長文の語句空所補充 Q19-Q21

次の英文A, Bを読み, その文意にそって(19)から(24)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを選びなさい。

Bird Battle

When Australian soldiers returned home after fighting abroad in World War I, many had trouble finding employment. The public pressured the government to support the former soldiers, and they were eventually offered plots of land to become crop farmers. Thousands of people (19). This is despite the fact that the soil quality was often poor, and some plots were considered too small to bring in enough income.

Once settled, some farmers faced another issue: emus. Emus are large flightless birds that migrate hundreds of kilometers in search of food and water. As agricultural land expanded, clashes between emus and farmers increased. At the time, the emus had protected status. (20), the farmers' options were severely limited. They built simple fences, but the emus overcame these barriers and destroyed crops. The farmers were eventually permitted to kill the birds. However, the early 1930s saw a severe drought that led to huge numbers of emus migrating to the Campion district of Western Australia. In desperation, the farmers there called on the government to assist them.

Soldiers armed with machine guns were sent to eliminate thousands of emus. Within days, it became clear that the (21). As soon as they became aware of potential danger, the emus broke into small groups and ran in different directions, making it extremely difficult for the soldiers to use their weapons effectively. After a relatively short time, the hunt was postponed. Although later attempts had slightly more success, the whole program was generally deemed ineffective and eventually scrapped.

- (19)

1 returned to their hometowns

2 refused to become farmers

3 accepted the challenge

4 chose to stay in the army
- (20)

1 For instance

2 Nevertheless

3 Consequently

4 Instead
- (21)

1 task would not be easy

2 soldiers were well trained

3 emus were unable to escape

4 farmers could assist the soldiers

大問2B 長文の語句空所補充 Q22-Q24

次の英文A, Bを読み, その文意にそって(19)から(24)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを選びなさい。

Gladiator Equality

Hollywood movies have helped to make scenes of gladiators fighting each other in public arenas an iconic part of ancient Rome's history. Historical records show that gladiatorial games began in pre-Roman communities and that the Romans then adopted them as a form of entertainment around the third century BC. Unlike in the movies, however, it was uncommon for gladiators to die in the arena. (22), losers could give up and admit defeat, and whether they lived or died would then be decided by the sponsor of the games. Having a gladiator killed resulted in paying a large fee to their owner, so it rarely happened.

Many people may also be surprised to learn that gladiators were not always men. Some historians believe that female gladiators appeared during the first century BC, at a time when Roman society was undergoing many changes. Rome was transitioning from a republic to an empire, and women were starting to be allowed greater freedom. In addition, people were spending more money on entertainment, and audiences demanded novelty and excitement. One way to provide that was by (23).

As with their male counterparts, many female gladiators were slaves who fought to make money for their owners. However, some middle- and upper-class women (24). Historians believe there were several reasons for such women to do this. Some likely did it as a form of protest against their families or an escape from Rome's male-dominated society. Others probably did it because it brought them fame and excitement.

(22)

- 1 Despite this
- 2 Similarly
- 3 In fact
- 4 Therefore

(23)

- 1 making gladiators fight to the death
- 2 having women fight each other
- 3 increasing the prize money for gladiators
- 4 banning female gladiators

(24)

- 1 got married to famous gladiators
- 2 prohibited their slaves from becoming gladiators
- 3 enjoyed watching gladiatorial games
- 4 actively chose to become gladiators

大問3A 長文

本文を読み、次ページのQ25-Q27に答えなさい。

The Mary Celeste

In December 1872, the crew of the Dei Gratia, a British merchant ship that had set sail from New York, spotted another ship drifting in the Atlantic Ocean. The Dei Gratia's captain was surprised to see that the ship was the Mary Celeste, which had left New York weeks earlier and should have already arrived at its intended destination in Italy. He sent some of his men to investigate, but they found nobody aboard the Mary Celeste. However, the crew's belongings remained, the ship's cargo of industrial alcohol was still present, and there were plentiful supplies of food and water. The ship was undamaged, although there was some seawater in its cargo hold. Hoping to gain a financial reward for salvaging the deserted ship, the Dei Gratia's crew sailed the Mary Celeste to Gibraltar and handed it over to British authorities there.

No trace of the Mary Celeste's crew has ever been found, and there has been much speculation about what happened. One popular theory was that the ship was attacked by pirates, who murdered the crew and threw them overboard. This was rejected, however, since pirates generally stayed away from the area because British naval ships often patrolled there. Furthermore, the ship's cargo had not been stolen. Another theory was that vapors from the alcohol the Mary Celeste was carrying caused an explosion that forced the crew to leave the ship. However, the Dei Gratia's crew found no damage on the Mary Celeste that supported this idea.

To try and shed some light on the Mary Celeste mystery, documentary maker Anne MacGregor analyzed transcripts of the ship's log and official reports written in Gibraltar at the time. MacGregor now believes the ship was abandoned a few miles from the Azores Island of Santa Maria ten days before it was discovered by the Dei Gratia. She also found evidence that the ship's water pump had become blocked and its chronometer, which was a vital piece of navigational equipment, had been faulty. As a result, the Mary Celeste's captain would have been unsure of the ship's position and unable to remove seawater from the cargo hold. MacGregor thinks that these issues, combined with the fact that the Mary Celeste had experienced rough seas the day before, would have been enough to make the captain resort to sacrificing the ship in order to ensure his crew's safety. The question of why the crew never made it to Santa Maria remains unanswered, however.

大問3A 長文設問 Q25-Q27

前ページの本文を読み、最も適切なものを1つ選びなさい。

- (25) After finding the Mary Celeste drifting at sea, the crew of the Dei Gratia
- 1 gave supplies of water and food to the Mary Celeste's crew to prevent them from dying before reaching Italy.
 - 2 repaired the damage to the Mary Celeste, which was then able to continue its journey to Italy.
 - 3 contacted British authorities in Gibraltar, who came to salvage the Mary Celeste.
 - 4 took the Mary Celeste to Gibraltar because they thought they could make money by doing so.

- (26) What is true according to the passage?
- 1 British authorities suspected that the crew of the Dei Gratia stole the Mary Celeste's cargo and killed its crew.
 - 2 The Dei Gratia's crew refused to board the Mary Celeste at first because they believed its cargo was too dangerous.
 - 3 It is unlikely that pirates attacked the Mary Celeste because it was unusual for them to operate where the ship was discovered.
 - 4 Evidence found on the Mary Celeste suggests that damage to the ship was caused by an explosion.

- (27) What did Anne MacGregor conclude based on her investigation?
- 1 The mystery of what happened to the Mary Celeste would never be solved because official reports contain little information about the incident.
 - 2 Several factors led to the Mary Celeste's captain deciding he had no choice but to get his crew off the ship.
 - 3 The crew of the Mary Celeste likely escaped to Santa Maria to avoid being blamed for abandoning the ship.
 - 4 Records of the Mary Celeste's discovery were altered in order to cover up what really happened.

大問3B 長文

本文を読み、次ページのQ28-Q31に答えなさい。

The Science of Revenge

While revenge is a phenomenon found in cultures around the globe, this dark human instinct is still not fully understood. One famous psychological theory of the past viewed it as a way to release the buildup of rage or hatred that occurs in situations where a person feels victimized, just as releasing steam can decrease pressure in a steam engine. Psychological studies, however, have revealed that aggressive acts associated with revenge can actually leave people with increased levels of anger compared with those who do not attempt to get even.

It is generally agreed that evolution has played a part in bringing about the human tendency toward revenge. Revenge seems to be common in various animal species, and our close relatives, chimpanzees, frequently retaliate against aggression. Since they share much of our DNA, it suggests there is a biological mechanism at work. In addition, since human ancestors in ancient times faced frequent threats, such as murder and theft, an instinct for getting even would have proved beneficial in discouraging others from harming them. Research has also revealed that males, particularly those with greater upper-body strength, have a greater tendency toward revenge. This suggests that the drive to get even may be linked to evolutionary pressures since those who were more capable of enacting revenge had a better chance of survival and protecting the resources they needed to live.

However, human society may also have shaped revenge. Researchers have found that revenge tends to occur more frequently in societies where institutions for enforcing laws are less developed. Tribal peoples with no formal justice system, for example, are more likely to retaliate than people in urban settings with sophisticated law enforcement systems. Similarly, low-income neighborhoods in the United States often suffer from a lack of law enforcement, and there is a greater tendency for their residents to retaliate when they are victims of crime. While not proven, this cultural view of revenge appears useful for understanding the great degree of variation that exists in societies around the world.

A cultural approach to understanding the possible origins of revenge can also help explain its effects not just on individuals but on society as a whole. Taking revenge can come at great personal cost, including damage to human relationships, imprisonment, or even loss of life, as well as leading to a cycle of revenge. However, revenge may also send a message that affects the behavior of everyone in the society by making it clear that certain types of actions will not be tolerated. As well as making people aware of what not to do, it can indirectly lead to beneficial actions. For example, on a soccer team, if players put in little effort during practice, other players may resent them and avoid passing them the ball during the game. The potential for such retaliation can contribute to a team's overall motivation in practices. It is, therefore, possible that revenge developed because it can have a positive impact on the members of a group or society, reinforcing behaviors that contribute positively to its overall success.

大問3B 長文設問 Q28-Q31

前ページの本文を読み、最も適切なものを1つ選びなさい。

- (28) What is one thing that we learn about an older psychological theory of revenge?
- 1 It had a problem because it focused on the reasons that people wanted to get revenge rather than the degree of anger they felt.
 - 2 It was created using the results of a well-known psychological study, but it reached an incorrect conclusion about them.
 - 3 It was based on a misunderstanding about the relationship between victims and the people who cause harm to them.
 - 4 It incorrectly suggested that revenge worked to reduce the amount of negative emotion, such as anger, that a wronged person felt.
- (29) Which of the following is mentioned as an advantage of taking revenge for early humans?
- 1 It may have been a way for males to demonstrate their physical strength and their ability to protect females from danger.
 - 2 It could have helped to keep them safe from animals because it brought out anger, making them better able to respond to attacks.
 - 3 It would have had the effect of helping to prevent other people from trying to kill them or steal their belongings.
 - 4 It seems to have provided a way for them to handle stress related to suffering caused by the harmful actions of other humans.
- (30) The author mentions low-income neighborhoods in the United States as an example that
- 1 demonstrates that revenge seems to be more common in societies where the justice system is not working well.
 - 2 supports the idea that the desire to get revenge has an unexpected connection with how much wealth an individual possesses.
 - 3 shows that societies with strict punishments for criminals are likely to have much lower rates of crime than those that do not.
 - 4 helps to explain the changes that have come about as tribal societies gradually changed into more-modern ones.
- (31) According to the fourth paragraph, what is one positive effect of revenge?
- 1 It can actually strengthen personal relationships among people who feel that they have been the victims of harm from others.
 - 2 It can cause people to follow social rules so that they are more likely to behave in a way that is acceptable to the group.
 - 3 It can allow individuals a chance to make a situation fairer when they are being treated badly by the rest of society.
 - 4 It can indirectly lead to increased competition that can cause many people in society to enjoy greater success.

正解一覧

すべて解き終えてから確認してください。 大問3は正解番号のみを表示しています。



Q01-Q11	Q12-Q21	Q22-Q31
Q014 diverted4	Q123 intentionally3	Q223 In fact3
Q022 outburst2	Q132 obligation2	Q232 having women fight each other2
Q034 prompt4	Q141 interact1	Q244 actively chose to become gladiators4
Q042 potency2	Q153 take up3	Q254
Q051 distracts1	Q162 track down2	Q263
Q062 privatized2	Q174 set off4	Q272
Q073 irrelevant3	Q182 pass up2	Q284
Q081 hazardous1	Q193 accepted the challenge3	Q293
Q093 invalid3	Q203 Consequently3	Q301
Q101 loophole1	Q211 task would not be easy1	Q312
Q111 vivid1		

学習記録

得点

/ 31

やり直す問題

メモ